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THE MONTHLY NEWSLETTER FOR RESIDENTS OF THE MPII CDD

MPII NEWS



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Meadow Pointe II Clubhouse

30051 County Line Rd
Wesley Chapel, FL
33543
813-991-5016

clubhouse@mpiicdd.org
www.meadowpointe2cdd.org
Facebook.com/MPIICDD

Operations Manager

Justin Wright
justinwright@mpiicdd.org

Office Hours

Daily 8am—8:45pm

Fitness Center

M-F 7am—8:45pm
S/S 8am—8:45pm

Pool

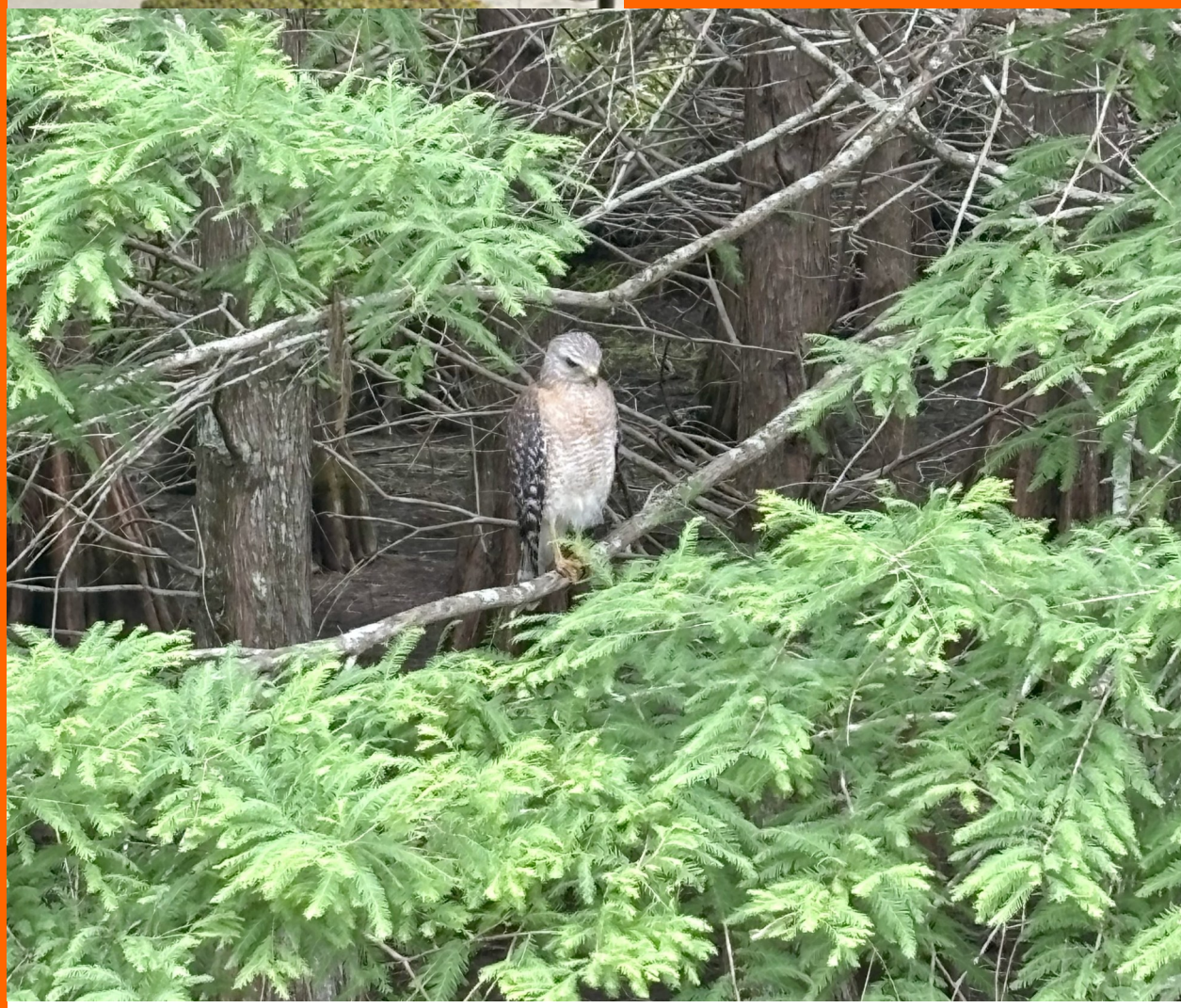
Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Playground

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Courts

Daily 8am—8:45pm



A red-shouldered hawk perches in Tullamore. These native birds are wonderful at controlling mouse, frog, and snake populations as they hunt and feed on all three. They very rarely affect pets or humans. Another great example of the beauty of nature in and around Meadow Pointe II.

Photo courtesy of Justina Perkins.

MPII CDD Board of Supervisors

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The CDD Board of Supervisors holds public meetings twice each month. These are held on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays at 6:30 pm in the Clubhouse.

All MPII residents are welcomed and encouraged to attend. This is your CDD and attending meetings is the best way to stay informed and share your input.

Back to School

For all MPII residents, whether you're a daily commuter with no school age children, a parent of school age kids, or retired and living the good life, you surely feel like the school year *just* ended. This is especially true if you're one of the MPII residents who attend school somewhere in our community. However – summer is officially over for Pasco (and Hillsborough) County students!



Both Pasco and Hillsborough public schools have their first day of the 2025-2026 school year on Monday, August 11th. Teachers will obviously be back a bit before that, and bus drivers will be making practice/test runs to master the timing of their scheduled routes before that date as well. So, for all intents and purposes, school is *back*. On top of public schools, PHSC (8/18), USF (8/25), St. Leo (8/25) and UT (8/25) all begin fall classes during this month.

If you're a commuter, NOW is the time to adjust your morning schedule and departure time to avoid incurring the boss's wrath for being late. It's also a great way to reduce stress! Leaving a bit early and not being in a rush to be on time will make you a safer driver, less stressed, and happier!

If you're a student, be very careful getting to school in the mornings! For kids aged 5-19, unintentional pedestrian injuries are the 5th leading cause of injury related death in the U.S. Do your part to be as safe as possible. If you walk, stay alert, stay on sidewalks, and cross using crosswalks. If you bike or board to school, wear protective gear – especially a helmet! Obey the rules for bicycles and pedestrians.

If you're a parent who drives your child or a carpool, leave extra early the first week. Many families of kids who will ultimately be walkers or riders will drive their kids the first few days, so the drop off/pick up lines will typically be their longest of the month. Also, critically, please do not...

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Monthly MPII Trivia

Trivia – What famous event rocked the art world on August 21, 1911?

Answer on page 5.

Driving Safety

For the last several months, MPII residents have noticed a marked uptick in car accidents on I-75 in our immediate area (typically within a few miles north or south of SR 56). With the rapid and consistent growth our area has undergone over the last two decades, there are more drivers in our area and the added traffic can make our roads more dangerous.



Doubtless nearly every MPII resident has been impacted by one of these accidents. But driving safety is not limited to interstates. It's vital that we all drive responsibly everywhere, but perhaps it's even more critical that we drive safely within our own community. The safety of our neighbors depends on it.

Toward that end, residents are reminded that we must drive the speed limit on all the roads throughout our community. It's also important to remember that with over 100 ponds and lots of acreage dedicated to conservation land, we *share* our community with lots of animals – many of which are legally protected species.

So, if you're driving and see an animal in the road, or other vehicles stopped to permit them to safely cross out of the street, just be patient and wait for the animal to safely get out of the road. Many species of turtles, several birds (especially sandhill cranes), and occasionally an alligator will be on or near our roadways. To help ensure their safety, new signs were recently erected on County Line Road (see photo) to remind drivers.

Another factor that will affect area drivers is the increasing volume of vehicles on the road this time of year. With schools starting up throughout August, and September and October being the peak months for snowbird arrivals, there will simply be a larger volume of traffic on the roadways in our area. We must prepare for this and allocate more time for our commutes.

Also, perhaps the most essential reason to drive safely within the community is that our neighbors are often pedestrians. Our MPII area is blessed to have countless sidewalks and bike lanes, as well as a full range of levels of community schools. And, at the center of MPII is the...

Driving Safety continues on page 4...

MPII Management Company

Inframark
Jayna Cooper
Jayna.Cooper@inframark.com
813-608-8242

CDD fee/Bond Questions

Inframark Accounting Department
954-603-0033

The MPII Clubhouse offers MPII residents Notary Services at no cost.

We have a certified Notary on staff, please call ahead for availability.

Back to School

Continued from page 2

park along streets for drop off or pick up. This is illegal in Pasco County, and it exacerbates school time traffic.

Additionally, *ALL* MPII residents need to be vigilant about school bus safety. Keep a very safe distance behind them, NEVER pass a bus once its flashing lights come on, wait patiently for all the students to board or exit the bus and get to the sidewalk. Please do not become impatient or irritated if it appears a bus is sitting there for no obvious (to you) reason. The bus driver may see and be waiting for a child who is running a few seconds late, or has special needs, or who simply dropped something. Also please remember that Mansfield Boulevard and Beardsley Drive within MPII have no medians, so drivers on both sides of the street must stop for all buses. However, County Line Road *IS* divided, so opposite direction drivers may proceed normally. However, opposite direction drivers should remain very vigilant and be prepared to yield to pedestrians crossing the street. Perhaps most importantly, all drivers *must always* yield to pedestrians in crosswalks.

Another important reminder for anyone commuting on Mansfield Boulevard – the relatively new businesses that have already opened as well as continuing construction have the potential to further complicate traffic flow. Please take that into account if you're headed to any of the four schools in that area (Wiregrass Ranch High, Pasco Hernando State College - Porter Campus, John Long Middle, or Wiregrass Elementary) or your commute takes you out Mansfield to SR56 as drive times will be a little longer than last school year.

With common sense, a little patience, and a little preparation, the transition back to the school year will be smooth, easy, and most importantly – safe for all MPII residents.

https://www.nsc.org/home-safety/seasonal-safety/back-to-school

Driving Safety

Continued from page 3

Clubhouse, complete with sports courts, pools, a playground, and a fitness center. So, please drive safely within Meadow Pointe. Stay on the lookout for children (OR adults) on bicycles or other wheeled vehicles, and pedestrians. To help with pedestrian safety, there are two flashing crosswalk lighted signs on County Line Road (see photo) and one on Mansfield Boulevard (aside from red light intersections). If



you are driving on our roads and see this light flashing yellow, you MUST yield to any pedestrian attempting to cross.

Meadow Pointe II is a wonderful and safe community. Let's all remember to be courteous to our neighbors when we drive within our residential areas and continue to be great neighbors who ensure the safety of our friends, our animals, and ourselves.

August Holidays



August 1st – Lughnasadh. This is a Gaelic festival, still celebrated in parts of the U.K. as well as by Wiccans and Pagans. It celebrates and marks the beginning of harvest season and is celebrated in the U.K. often with pilgrimages, but most modern celebrations involve fairs, festivals, and similar happy community gatherings. Happy Lughnasadh!

August 3rd – Tisha B'Av. Beginning at sundown on the 2nd, the Jewish community worldwide honors a 25 hour fast and several other sacrifices to commemorate their "saddest day", a day in their calendar where five different calamities occurred on this same date on their calendar. For those that participate, have a blessed fast on this solemn day.



August 11th – Back to School. This of course is not a holiday, though many parents give it reverence as such. However, it is a noteworthy date since this affects all the students, the teachers, numerous other school employees, and most daily commuters. Be careful out there!



August 15th – The Assumption of Mary. This holiday is honored by several Christian groups, most notably the Catholics. It is a major feast day that commemorates and celebrates Mary's transition to Heaven. For those that celebrate: Happy Assumption Day!



Trivia Answer (from page 2): The Mona Lisa was stolen from the Louvre!

The iconic painting, completed in 1507, was lost for over two years. It was recovered in December of 1913 when one of the thieves tried to sell it. While the Mona Lisa was unheralded until the 1860's, the notoriety of the painting exploded due to the theft and subsequent recovery.

https://www.npr.org/2011/07/30/138800110/the-theft-that-made-the-mona-lisa-a-masterpiece



HCSO Cruise Lights

For the safety of all first responders, we all know that when we see the flashing lights of an emergency vehicle we are supposed to slow down and/or pull over to let the first responder vehicle through to respond to whatever emergency they are hurrying toward.

Drivers from Meadow Pointe, which is just north of the county line with Hillsborough County, frequently drive into or through Hillsborough on a nearly daily basis. So, even though this applies only to Hillsborough County Sheriff Office vehicles, MPII residents have surely noticed this recent change: HCSO vehicles have started using cruise lights. Cruise lights are non-flashing red and blue lights on their vehicles (not accompanied by sirens) that stay on nearly all the time.

To many drivers, this can be confusing. At the sight of red and blue lights on a sheriff office vehicle, drivers tend to react as if it's a first responder hurrying to an emergency. However, this is not the case with cruise lights. Cruise lights are being used simply to raise awareness of the presence of the HCSO and as a crime (traffic crimes or otherwise) deterrent.

So, if you are driving in or through Hillsborough County and spot the solid, non-flashing red and blue lights, continue driving *normally* (though safely of course) and do not react as you would when you see the flashing lights and/or sirens. As of the time of this writing, cruise lights are only a policy for Hillsborough, not Pasco, Pinellas, Tampa, Clearwater, or state troopers.

Hopefully raising this awareness will help drivers maintain safety. Drivers overreacting to seeing the cruise lights could, theoretically, create dangerous driving conditions unnecessarily. Let's all stay safe out on the roads. For more information, our local ABC news affiliate did a story on this as well.

Tampa Bay Comic Con

Festivals are wonderful events, and the Tampa Bay area has *lots* of great festivals that MPII residents can attend. The Tampa Bay Comic and Pop Culture Convention (TBCC) is here once again. It's being held at the Tampa Bay Convention Center and is expected to host over 50,000 people over the three days from August 1st – August 3rd.

Don't be fooled into thinking that only the nerdiest among us would enjoy the TBCC. This festival has events that nearly everyone will enjoy. Numerous celebrities from multiple genres (film, TV, comics, and more) will be in attendance, with most offering the opportunity to meet them or get an autograph or photo (most will have fees). There are also cosplay contests, vendors, artists, and many authors will be there as well. If this sounds fun to you or someone in your family, more information is available at www.tampabaycomicconvention.com.

There's a lot more good news though. Our area is teeming with festivals, conventions, and all sorts of similar events all year long. We are quite fortunate to live in the Tampa Bay area. Other great events held close by include Gasparilla (parades, a film festival , a car show, a music festival, an arts festival, and multiple running races), the Florida State Fair (February), the Strawberry Festival each March, the Greek Festival every November, a Blues Festival, a Margarita Festival, and countless other great activities! To find out more about events that *you* might enjoy, go to www.visittampabay.com, or www.tampa.gov/calendar.

We live in a phenomenal area, so get out there and enjoy what Tampa Bay has to offer so close to home!

Upcoming EPC Events

The MPII Events Planning Committee (EPC) is essentially on a brief hiatus during the peak heat of the summer. However, they will have more events resuming in October, which will of course include the amazing Halloween FunFest!

And, they do have another community clean-up scheduled for September! This event will take place on Saturday, September 20th. Volunteers should meet up at the Clubhouse parking lot (east end) by 8am. This is a great opportunity to work with your fellow community members to achieve a real improvement for the appearance of our neighborhood as well as minimize adverse effects on our ecosystem and



environment. It's also a fantastic way for high school students to rack up a few community service hours right here close to home!

As a reminder, the EPC presents numerous fantastic events that appeal to residents of all ages. Some are festival-type events, some are yard competitions, some are community clean-ups, and they even hosted a shred event this year as well.

Not only that, but the EPC offers tons of great volunteer opportunities throughout the year. They frequently need volunteers to assist with setting up events, cleaning up after events, and working during events. These are volunteer opportunities that do not require any special skills or training and are done right here in your own community. They are phenomenal opportunities for residents of all ages, but especially for high schoolers who need community service hours for scholarships! And families can volunteer together!

Stay tuned for more awesome upcoming EPC community events! If you want to know about upcoming events before you even read about them in our newsletter, email the EPC and ask to be included in their email blasts about events and volunteer opportunities! They can be reached at mpiiepc@gmail.com and they have their own Facebook page.

MPII Clubs & Opportunities



EC TENNIS ACADEMY offers tennis lessons to people aged 4 through adult. Contact Coach Edgardo Chavez at 813-328-0841.

Teach Leaf

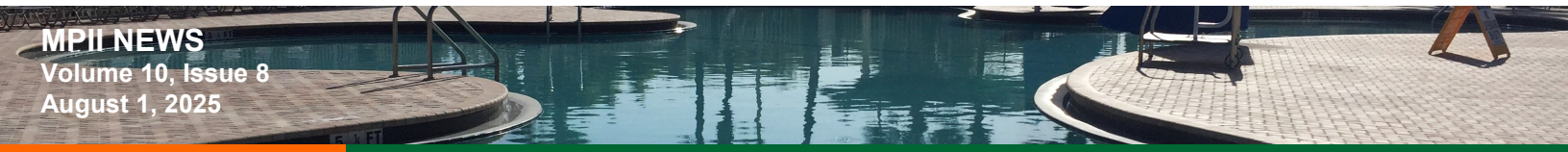
TEACH LEAF is now enrolling for the 2025-2026 school year! The KLP, or Kindergarten Learning Pod, will meet on Mondays and Wednesdays at the MPII Clubhouse. This is a great opportunity for the children in our community! For more details or to enroll in the camp please contact Melissa Goebel at teacher.melissa827@gmail.com.

YARN CLUB meets every Thursday night from 6 – 8 pm. Open to all adults who knit or crochet – all skill levels welcome.



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MPII News Needs Your Photos!

If you have taken a photo within MPII that you think would make a nice cover shot on a future issue, please email it to newsletter@mpiicdd.org. Submitting a photo gives us permission to use it in the newsletter. If there are people in the photo, please ensure that we have their permission to publish their photo.

Also, remember that the Clubhouse has an opt-in email list for receiving the newsletter as a PDF each month! To opt-in, just email newsletter@mpiicdd.org and tell us what email address or addresses you'd like us to include. As of now, the Clubhouse only uses this list for the newsletter, but we may include other time-sensitive announcements in the future.